From fine dining in spectacular settings to lavish spa therapies, the Ritz-Carlton and St. Regis offer much pampering









quiet except for the occasional hullaballoo of monkeys.

I had arrived in time to grab an energising lunch of superfood salads and juicy lobster tacos at the Beach Grill. In the late afternoon, we set off on a catamaran ride into the Andaman Sea which culminated in a sumptuous dinner rustled up by an on-board chef—and a stunning sunset. But the gesture that stole my heart was finding, upon returning to my room in the evening, that someone had run a bubble bath and strewn it generously with rose petals—just what I needed after a tiring day. I could get used to this!

Next morning, a most lavish breakfast awaited me at the Langkawi Kitchen, a restaurant whose architecture is inspired by the longhouses of Borneo. You work up an appetite as you walk down the covered walkway to the restaurant entrance. Apart from the usual buffet offerings, there were a plethora of local options, and I didn't hesitate to tuck into roti jala, kaya toast & egg, and some chana masala, all washed down with teh tarik. But the culinary high point of the Ritz-Carlton stay was a multi-course dinner at Hai Yan, a modern Chinese restaurant perched on stilts above weathered rocks and crashing waves.